

**BEFORE THE BOARD OF BEHAVIORAL HEALTH PROFESSIONALS OF THE
STATE OF IOWA**

IN THE MATTER OF

Giovanni Demezier
License No. 092633

RESPONDENT

**CASE NOs.: 24-0325 & 24-0485
DIAL NO.: 25DBBH0009**

**VOLUNTARY SURRENDER OF
LICENSE THROUGH CONSENT
ORDER AND SETTLEMENT
AGREEMENT**

COME NOW the Iowa Board of Behavioral Health Professionals (“Board”) and Giovanni Demezier (“Respondent”) and enter into this Voluntary Surrender of License through Consent Order (“Voluntary Surrender”) pursuant to Iowa Code sections 17A.10(1) and 272C.3(4).

A. JURISDICTION AND BACKGROUND

1. **Iowa License.** Respondent was issued Iowa license number 092633 on May 21, 2021. Respondent’s license will next expire on September 30, 2026.
2. **Jurisdiction.** The Board has jurisdiction in this matter pursuant to Iowa Code chapter 154D.

B. STATEMENT OF CHARGES

COUNT I

3. Respondent is charged with unethical conduct, in violation of 481 Iowa Administrative Code rule 504.2(27)(b).

COUNT II

4. Respondent is charged with failure to comply with the national association’s code of ethics, in violation of 481 Iowa Administrative Code rule 893.1(1).

COUNT III

5. Respondent is charged with engaging in sexual activities or sexual contact with a former client, in violation of 481 Iowa Administrative Code rule 893.1(2)(b).

C. FACTUAL CIRCUMSTANCES

6. Respondent was a licensed mental health counselor providing counseling services in and around Eastern Iowa, during the relevant time periods below.

7. In or around January 2024, Respondent began providing counseling services to T.S.. The client-counseling relationship between T.S. and Respondent ended in or around the beginning of May 2024. Prior to terminating the client counseling relationship, Respondent and T.S. communicated with each other on Snapchat. T.S. indicated to Respondent that they wanted something “more” with Respondent, to which Respondent indicated that in order to have that, he would switch them from a counseling client to a “coaching” client. Respondent indicated that coaching and counseling were “virtually the same”.

8. Respondent had sexual contact with T.S. in or around June 2024.

9. In or around 2021, Respondent began providing counseling services to M.R. via telehealth sessions. During their client-counseling relationship, Respondent made repeated suggestive and flirtatious comments to M.R. The client-counseling relationship transitioned the services to a “coaching” relationship in or around August 2023. On or around October 28, 2024, Respondent initiated a sexual conversation with M.R. via text message. M.R. terminated their relationship due to these communications on or around October 31, 2024.

D. SETTLEMENT AGREEMENT

10. Respondent has reviewed the factual circumstances and charges alleged by the Board. Without admitting the factual circumstances asserted or violation of the charges, Respondent acknowledges a likelihood that a hearing on the merits would result in a finding Respondent violated the above-stated charges. In order to amicably resolve the matter presented before the Board, Respondent has agreed to enter into this Voluntary Surrender of License through Consent Order.

11. Respondent acknowledges that they have a right to a hearing before the Iowa Board of Behavioral Health Professionals on the merits of the charges. By freely and voluntarily entering into this Voluntary Surrender, Respondent waives their right to a hearing and all attendant rights, including the right to seek judicial review. This Voluntary Surrender constitutes the final agency order in this contested case pursuant to Iowa Code § 17A.10.

12. Respondent agrees that the Assistant Attorney General may present this Voluntary Surrender to the Iowa Board of Behavioral Health Professionals and may have *ex parte* communications with the Iowa Board of Behavioral Health Professionals while presenting it. Respondent waives any right of notice of this meeting or any right that the Respondent might have to participate in the discussion of this Voluntary Surrender among the Iowa Board of Behavioral Health Professionals and the Assistant Attorney General.

13. This Voluntary Surrender shall be part of the disciplinary record and permanent licensure file of Respondent and shall be considered by the Iowa Board of Behavioral Health Professionals in determining the nature and severity of any future disciplinary action to be imposed

in the event of any future violations of the laws and rules governing the practice of a behavioral health professionals by the Respondent.

14. Respondent shall at all future times fully and promptly comply with all pertinent orders of the Board and the statutes and Board rules regulating the practice of behavioral health professionals. Failure to comply with the terms of this Voluntary Surrender shall be *prima facie* evidence of a violation of Iowa Code §272C.3(2)(a) and shall be grounds for further disciplinary action. However, no action may be taken against Respondent for violations of this Voluntary Surrender without a hearing, or waiver of hearing.

15. This Voluntary Surrender is not binding on Respondent or the Iowa Board of Behavioral Health Professionals until it has been formally approved by a majority of the Iowa Board of Behavioral Health Professionals members.

(a) In the event that this Voluntary Surrender is rejected by the Iowa Board of Behavioral Health Professionals it shall be of no force or effect to either party and it shall not be admissible for any purpose in further proceedings in this matter.

(b) If the Iowa Board of Behavioral Health Professionals approves this Voluntary Surrender, it shall fully dispose of all issues in this case.

16. Upon acceptance by both the Board and Respondent, this Voluntary Surrender shall be a public record available for inspection and copying in its entirety in accordance with the requirements of Iowa Code chapter 22.

17. Respondent understands that the Board is required by Federal law to report this Voluntary Surrender to the National Practitioner Database.

18. Respondent shall submit a copy of this Voluntary Surrender to all licensing boards where Respondent holds a license, whether active or not, within **THIRTY days** of the date of the Board approval of this Voluntary Surrender.

CONSENT ORDER

IT IS THEREFORE ORDERED:

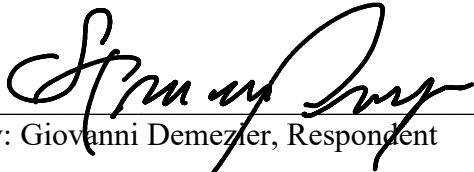
A. VOLUNTARY SURRENDER: The Respondent voluntarily agrees to surrender his Iowa License 092633 to the Iowa Board of Behavioral Health Professionals as settlement for the charges alleged. The effective date of the license surrender shall be the date this Voluntary Surrender is accepted by the Board.

B. LICENSEE REAPPLICATION: Reinstatement of Respondent's Iowa license shall be governed by Iowa Code § 272C.15. Respondent specifically acknowledges that pursuant to this agreement, Respondent shall not be eligible to seek reinstatement of their license for a minimum of one year from the date his license surrender is effective.

WHEREFORE, the terms of this Voluntary Surrender of License through Consent Order is agreed to by the Iowa Board of Behavioral Health Professionals and Respondent.

FOR THE RESPONDENT:

Voluntarily agreed to and accepted by Giovanni Demezier on this 7th day of August, 2025.


By: Giovanni Demezier, Respondent

FOR THE IOWA BOARD OF BEHAVIORAL HEALTH PROFESSIONALS:

Voluntarily agreed to and accepted by the **IOWA BOARD OF BEHAVIORAL HEALTH PROFESSIONALS** on this 2nd day of September, 2025.

Aaron L Culley, LSW

AARON CULLEY Chairperson
Iowa Board of Behavioral Health Professionals